

Word family: **life / lives / lifelong / lifetime / lifelike / lifeless**

Base word: life

Plural: lives

Related forms / useful extensions: lifetime, lifelong, lifelike, lifeless, life expectancy, lifespan, battery life, shelf life, service life

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “At the same time, the ad mentioned practical features like comfort, **battery life**, and sound quality, so it still felt believable.”

A useful point first: **life** has several genuinely distinct modern meanings, and **battery life** is an important figurative/technical extension. Here, **life** does not mean biological life. It means **the length of time something remains usable or continues functioning**.

Meaning in this passage

battery life means:

the amount of time a battery or battery-powered device can operate before the battery needs to be recharged or replaced.

繁體中文: 電池在需要重新充電或更換之前，能夠持續供電並讓裝置正常運作的時間長度

中文翻譯:

> “The ad mentioned practical features like comfort, battery life, and sound quality...”

「廣告亦提到了舒適度、電池續航時間和音質等實際功能特點.....」

battery life = 電池一次充電後可持續使用的時間／電池續航力

1. **life** = living state of a person/animal/organism (生命狀態) — 生命; 生存

Meaning: The state of being alive rather than dead.

Practice 1

> “Doctors managed to save his **life**.”

「醫生成功**挽救了他的生命**。」

Practice 2

> “Scientists continue to search for signs of **life** on other planets.”

「科學家繼續尋找其他星球上是否存在**生命**的跡象。」

****life = 生物處於活著、生存而非死亡的狀態****

2. ****life = period from birth to death (人的一生) — 一生; 生命歷程****

****Meaning:**** The entire period during which a person or living thing is alive.

Practice 3

> “She spent most of her **life** in Hong Kong.”

「她**一生的大部分時間**都在香港度過。」

Practice 4

> “His **life** changed completely after the accident.”

「那宗事故後，他的**人生**徹底改變了。」

****life = 從出生到死亡之間的整段人生／生命歷程****

Notice the Chinese naturally changes:

* ****save a life**** → 拯救生命

* ****throughout her life**** → 在她一生中

* ****his life changed**** → 他的人生改變了

3. ****life = way someone lives / personal existence (生活) — 生活; 日常生活****

****Meaning:**** The activities, experiences, relationships, and circumstances that make up someone's everyday existence.

Practice 5

> “Work is only one part of **life**.”

「工作只是**生活**的一部分。」

Practice 6

> “She wants a better balance between work and personal **life**.”

「她希望在工作 and 個人**生活**之間取得更好的平衡。」

life = 構成一個人日常存在的活動、經歷、人際關係和生活情況

Common expressions:

* **daily life** = 日常生活

* **family life** = 家庭生活

* **social life** = 社交生活

* **working life** = 職業生涯／工作生活

4. **life** = particular type/aspect of existence (某種生活方式／領域) —生活;生涯

Meaning: A particular aspect, stage, or type of someone's life.

Practice 7

> “University **life** can be very different from school.”

「大學**生活**跟中學生活可以非常不同。」

Practice 8

> “He enjoys city **life** but misses the countryside.”

「他喜歡城市**生活**，但也很想念鄉郊。」

life = 在某種環境、階段或角色下形成的一種生活方式／人生經歷

This is really a contextual branch of #3 rather than an unrelated meaning.

5. **life = living things collectively (生物／生態) — 生物; 生命形式**

Meaning: Living organisms considered generally or collectively.

Practice 9

> “The forest contains a rich variety of plant and animal **life**.”

「森林中有非常豐富的動植物**生態／生命形式**。」

Practice 10

> “Marine **life** is threatened by pollution.”

「海洋**生物**正受到污染威脅。」

life = 某個環境中存在的生物或生命形式的總稱

6. **life = energy/excitement/activity (活力／生氣) — 活力; 生氣; 熱鬧氣氛**

This is an important figurative meaning.

Meaning: Energy, excitement, movement, or liveliness.

Practice 11

> “The music brought the party to **life**.”

「音樂令派對變得**充滿活力和生氣**。」

Practice 12

> “The café is full of **life** in the evening.”

「這間咖啡店晚上**充滿活力, 非常熱鬧**。」

life = 令人或地方顯得活躍、有精神、有生氣的 energies 和氣氛

7. **life = period something continues to exist/function (事物的使用／存在壽命) — 壽命; 使用期限**

This is the broad technical concept behind **battery life**.

Meaning: The period during which a product, component, system, or material remains functional or useful.

Practice 13

> “Regular maintenance can extend the **life** of the machine.”

「定期保養可以延長機器的**使用壽命**。」

Practice 14

> “The coating increases the **life** of the equipment.”

「這層塗層可以延長設備的**使用年限／壽命**。」

life — product/equipment = 某個物件能持續正常運作或保持可用狀態的時間

8. **battery life** (電池／電池裝置) — 電池續航時間; 續航力

This is your original use.

Meaning: The time a battery-powered device can continue operating before it needs recharging or battery replacement.

Practice 15 — Original

> “The ad mentioned practical features like comfort, **battery life**, and sound quality.”

「廣告提到了舒適度、**電池續航時間**和音質等實際功能。」

Practice 16

> “These headphones have excellent **battery life**.”

「這副耳機的**電池續航力**非常出色。」

Practice 17

> “Turning off noise cancellation can improve **battery life**.”

「關閉降噪功能可以延長**一次充電後的使用時間**。」

****battery life = 電池在需要充電或更換前能持續讓裝置運作的時間****

A useful nuance: depending on context, ****battery life**** can sometimes also refer more broadly to ****how long the battery remains healthy before permanently degrading/requiring replacement****, but in consumer electronics advertising it very often means ****runtime per charge****.

9. ****shelf life (產品／食物) — 保存期限; 貨架壽命****

****Meaning:**** The length of time a product, especially food or medicine, remains suitable for use, sale, or consumption.

Practice 18

> “Fresh bread has a short ****shelf life****.”

「新鮮麵包的****保存期限很短****。」

Practice 19

> “The new packaging extends the product’s ****shelf life****.”

「新包裝延長了產品的****保存期限****。」

****shelf life = 產品在品質仍然合適、安全或可銷售的情況下能保存多久****

10. ****service life (設備／零件) — 使用壽命; 服役年限****

****Meaning:**** The period during which equipment or a component can perform its intended function satisfactorily.

Practice 20

> “The filter has a ****service life**** of approximately two years.”

「這個濾芯的****有效使用壽命****大約是兩年。」

Practice 21

> “Proper maintenance can increase the ****service life**** of the equipment.”

「適當保養可以延長設備的****可正常使用年限****。」

****service life = 設備或零件能維持正常功能並符合使用要求的年限****

11. ****lifespan = total length of existence/function (生物／物件的總壽命) — 壽命; 存在年期****

A very useful family extension.

Practice 22

> “The average ****lifespan**** of the animal is about fifteen years.”

「這種動物的平均****壽命****約為十五年。」

Practice 23

> “Heavy use may shorten the ****lifespan**** of the battery.”

「頻繁使用可能縮短電池的****整體使用壽命****。」

****lifespan = 某個生物或物件從開始存在／運作到結束的總時間****

12. ****lifetime = entire period of a person's or thing's existence — 一生; 整個使用期****

****Meaning:**** The whole duration of someone's life or something's useful existence.

Practice 24

> “She achieved more in a ****lifetime**** than most people could imagine.”

「她在****一生之中****取得了很多成就。」

Practice 25

> “The manufacturer offers a ****lifetime**** warranty.”

「製造商提供****終身／產品使用期保養****。」

****lifetime = 一個人整個一生, 或某物整段存在／使用期限****

Be careful: ****lifetime warranty**** does not always legally mean “for as long as the buyer lives”; the exact defined period

depends on the warranty terms.

13. ****lifelong** = continuing for an entire life — 終身的; 一生持續的******

Practice 26

> “She has been a ****lifelong**** music lover.”

「她****一生都熱愛音樂****。」

Practice 27

> “Education can encourage ****lifelong**** learning.”

「教育可以鼓勵****終身學習****。」

****lifelong** = 從人生很長一段時間持續到一生、或預期持續一生的******

14. ****lifelike** = looking very similar to something alive/real — 栩栩如生的; 逼真的******

Practice 28

> “The statue looks remarkably ****lifelike****.”

「這座雕像看起來非常****栩栩如生、像真人一樣****。」

Practice 29

> “The game uses highly ****lifelike**** animations.”

「這款遊戲使用非常****逼真的人物動畫****。」

****lifelike** = 外觀、動作或表現非常接近真實生物／真人的******

15. ****lifeless** = dead / showing no sign of life — 沒有生命的; 無生命跡象的******

Practice 30

> “The bird lay **lifeless** on the ground.”

「那隻鳥躺在地上，**已沒有生命跡象**。」

Practice 31

> “The plant looked dry and **lifeless**.”

「那株植物看起來乾枯而**毫無生氣**。」

lifeless = 沒有生命，或看起來完全沒有生命跡象的

16. **lifeless** = dull, lacking energy or excitement (表演／地方／作品) — 沒有生氣的；沉悶的

This is the figurative extension of #15.

Practice 32

> “The performance felt flat and **lifeless**.”

「這場表演感覺平淡而**缺乏活力和感染力**。」

Practice 33

> “The room looked cold and **lifeless**.”

「這個房間看起來冰冷而**毫無生氣**。」

lifeless = 缺乏活力、情感或吸引力，使人覺得沉悶的

Important distinction: **life vs lifetime**

life

Can mean:

- * life itself
- * someone's experiences
- * a product's useful duration

****lifetime****

specifically emphasizes the ****entire duration**** of a life/existence.

> “The machine has a long life.”

「這部機器使用壽命很長。」

> “Over its lifetime, the machine required little maintenance.”

「在整個使用期內，這部機器所需維修很少。」

Important distinction: ****life vs lifespan****

****life****

very broad.

****lifespan****

specifically means ****how long something lives or lasts****.

> “The battery has a long lifespan.”

= 電池整體壽命長。

This differs from:

> “The battery has long battery life.”

which often means:

= 一次充電可用很久。

That distinction is especially important for electronics.

Important distinction: ****battery life vs battery lifespan****

This is perhaps the most important distinction for your sentence.

battery life

In everyday consumer-tech language, often:

****how long the battery lasts before needing another charge****

> “20 hours of battery life”

= 一次充電可用約 20 小時。

battery lifespan

usually:

****how long the battery remains usable before age/wear means it needs replacement****

> “The battery lifespan is about four years.”

= 電池整體可使用約四年，之後可能需要更換。

So:

****battery life → 續航時間****

****battery lifespan → 電池整體壽命****

Important distinction: ****life vs lifestyle****

life

= someone's actual existence/experiences

lifestyle

= the characteristic way someone chooses or tends to live

> “City life is expensive.”

「城市生活成本高。」

> “He has a very active lifestyle.”

「他的生活方式非常活躍。」

Important distinction: **life vs living**

life

often means existence or one's whole experience.

living

can mean:

- * being alive;
- * one's way of earning money;
- * one's standard/conditions of daily existence.

> “the cost of living”

= 生活成本

not normally:

> *the cost of life*  for ordinary living expenses.

Important grammar/countability note: **life / lives**

The plural of **life** is:

> **lives**

not ***lives***.

Singular

> “one life”

「一條生命／一個人生」

Plural

> “many lives”

「很多條生命／很多人的人生」

Pronunciation also changes from **life** to **lives**, but since you haven't asked for pronunciation, we'll keep the focus on meaning here.

Family-extension note

Following our Golden Manual, useful practical extensions include:

- * **battery life** = 電池續航時間／續航力
- * **shelf life** = 保存期限
- * **service life** = 使用壽命
- * **lifespan** = 總壽命／存在年期
- * **lifetime** = 一生／整個存在或使用期
- * **lifelong** = 終身的
- * **lifelike** = 栩栩如生／逼真的
- * **lifeless** = 沒生命的；毫無生氣的
- * **life expectancy** = 預期壽命
- * **quality of life** = 生活質素
- * **way of life** = 生活方式
- * **life cycle** = 生命週期／產品生命週期
- * **life-saving** = 救命的
- * **life-threatening** = 危及生命的

The technical uses such as **battery life**, **shelf life**, **service life** all develop from one broader metaphor:

> **life** = how long something continues functioning or remains usable

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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life — biological state	生物處於活著、生存而非死亡的狀態
life — lifetime of a person	從出生到死亡之間的整段人生／生命歷程
life — everyday existence	構成一個人日常存在的活動、經歷、人際關係和生活情況
life — type of life	某種環境、階段或角色下形成的生活方式／人生經歷
life — organisms collectively	某個環境中的生物或生命形式總稱
life — energy/vitality	令人或地方顯得活躍、有精神、有生氣的的能量和氣氛
life — product/equipment	某個物件能持續正常運作或保持可用狀態的時間

battery life	電池在需要充電或更換前能持續讓裝置運作的時間	
shelf life	產品仍保持適合使用、食用或銷售狀態的保存期限	
service life	設備或零件能維持正常功能並符合使用要求的年限	
lifespan	生物或物件從開始存在／運作至結束的總時間	
lifetime	一個人整個一生, 或某物整段存在／使用期限	
lifelong	持續一生或人生大部分時間的	
lifelike	外觀或動作非常接近真人／真實生物、栩栩如生	
lifeless — literal	沒有生命或完全沒有生命跡象的	
lifeless — figurative	缺乏活力、情感或吸引力而顯得沉悶的	

For your original sentence

> “The ad mentioned practical features like comfort, ****battery life****, and sound quality...”

The exact meaning is:

****battery life = 電池在需要重新充電或更換之前, 能持續供電讓耳機正常使用的時間****

So in this context, the most natural Traditional Chinese is:

****battery life = 電池續航力／續航時間****

For example:

> “30 hours of battery life”

= ****一次充電可連續使用約 30 小時****。